▼ GLASSHOUSE



PROXY PROTEST

Chhattisgarh CM **Vishnu Deo Sai** has got his first taste of rebellion, with veteran BJP tribal leader and ex-minister **Nanki Ram Kanwar** threatening a dharna outside the CM's residence. The script, however, was swiftly rewritten as it was the same day Union home minister Amit Shah was visiting (October 3), and it wouldn't do to have such perfidy out in the open. So Kanwar was quietly "persuaded" to stay indoors in Raipur. But why was he upset? Well, apparently it was the CM's refusal to remove Korba collector Ajeet Vasant after alleged "irregularities". The subtext, though, hit a bit more closer to home—old BJP warhorses using Kanwar as a proxy to needle the soft-spoken Sai. Vasant, who has a reputation for not cowing down to local politicos, was collateral damage. The grapevine has it that some central Chhattisgarh veterans still can't digest Sai's rise and wouldn't mind another audition for the top post before the next election.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ LIGHTS, CAMERA, ELECTION

KERALA REELPOLITIK

With assembly polls due in six months, Kerala CM **Pinarayi Vijayan** is using every means to further the Left Front campaign. And that includes some good ol' celluloid charisma. The Left strongman rolled out the red carpet for **Mohanlal** after the actor's Dadasaheb Phalke award win, complete with a show titled 'Lal Salam'. On stage, though, filmmaker Adoor Gopalakrishnan was left wondering why his own Phalke (in 2004) hadn't triggered such fanfare. The answer lay not in art, but arithmetic. Back then, it was Congress veteran A.K. Antony at the helm, a man of more placid interests. Pinarayi, though 80, is still full of verve, and is apparently a cinephile—fave heroes include Rajinikanth, Kamal Haasan, Mammootty and Lal. Also, he knows that, in Kerala, nods to cultural icons go a long way with voters.

